Deliverable 01 – Business Case Analysis: Instructor Consultation Booking System

Author: Md Alamgir Hossain · October 2026 · *Illustrative case study: Walter Dvorak is the course instructor who acted as stakeholder. The interview answers and all figures here are illustrative examples prepared by the student team, not his actual statements.*

The business case supports building an Instructor Consultation Booking System. Email and paper-sheet booking costs the instructor about 3–4 hours a week, causes double-bookings and leaves no meeting record.

1. System request form

The system request is the formal starting point of the project (Chapter 2). Walter submits it as the user and requestor.

Field	Entry
Requestor	Walter Dvorak, Instructor BIS
Department	School of Business, Business Information Systems (BIS) program
Contact	By college email
Date submitted	October 2026
Title of request	Instructor Consultation Booking System
Type of request	New system
Main driver	Improved service to students; reduced instructor workload
Urgency	Medium. Wanted before the Winter 2027 term.
Problem description	Consultations are booked by email and a paper door sheet. This causes 2–4 rounds of email per booking, double-bookings, missed meetings and no meeting records.
Reason for request	Save instructor time, give students a faster way to book, and keep a record of every consultation.
Expected benefits	About 3–4 hours a week of scheduling time saved, fewer no-shows (target: from about 15% to under 5%), a searchable meeting history.
Constraints	Very small budget. Must work with Microsoft 365 (Outlook, Teams) and college logins. Must protect student data under provincial privacy law (FOIP).

2. Problem statement and business case

Problem statement: Booking a consultation with the instructor takes 2–4 rounds of email, and about 15% of booked meetings are missed. This wastes 3–4 instructor hours a week at peak times and gives students a slow, unreliable way to get help.

Current impact (illustrative figures)

Issue	Measure
Booking emails at peak times	40–60 per week
Instructor time spent scheduling	3–4 hours per week
Double-bookings (paper sheet vs Outlook)	2–3 per month
Missed meetings (no reminders)	About 15% of bookings
Meetings with notes recorded	Under half

Business case questions (Chapter 2)

Question	Answer
Why are we doing this project?	To remove manual scheduling work and improve the student consultation experience.
What is the project?	A web-based booking system where students self-book from the instructor's open slots and get reminders, and the instructor keeps private meeting notes.
How does it support business objectives?	It supports the college's focus on student success and on using staff time effectively.
What will it cost and how long will it take?	Low cost if built on the existing Microsoft 365 licence; about 8–10 weeks before Winter 2027. Details in Deliverable 02.
What happens if we do nothing?	The instructor keeps losing 3–4 hours a week, missed meetings continue, student names stay posted on a public door sheet, and there is still no meeting record.

Reasons for the systems request (Chapter 2: six main reasons)

Reason	Applies?	How
Improved service	Yes (main reason)	Students book online, any time, from any device
Better performance	Yes	One online step replaces 2–4 rounds of email
More information	Yes	Searchable meeting history and no-show data
Stronger controls	Yes	No double-bookings; no student names on a public door sheet; FOIP-compliant access
Reduced cost	Yes	Frees about 3.5 instructor hours a week
Support for new products and services	No	The consultation service itself does not change

Factors affecting the project (Chapter 2: internal and external)

Internal factors	External factors
Strategic plan: the college's focus on student success	Technology: cloud booking tools are now standard and low-cost
Top management: the program head must approve	Suppliers: Microsoft provides Bookings, Outlook and Teams
User requests: Walter and the students want self-booking	Customers: students expect self-service and mobile access
IT department: IT Services must enable and support the tool	Competitors: students already self-book with many other services
Existing systems: Microsoft 365, D2L Brightspace	Economy: tight public budgets mean little or no new spending
	Government: FOIP privacy rules for student information

Project type and priority: this is a **discretionary** project (management can choose whether to do it), not a nondiscretionary one such as a required tax update. Its priority is **medium-high**: it reduces costs, serves students better, produces more information, can be done in a reasonable time, and uses resources the college already has.

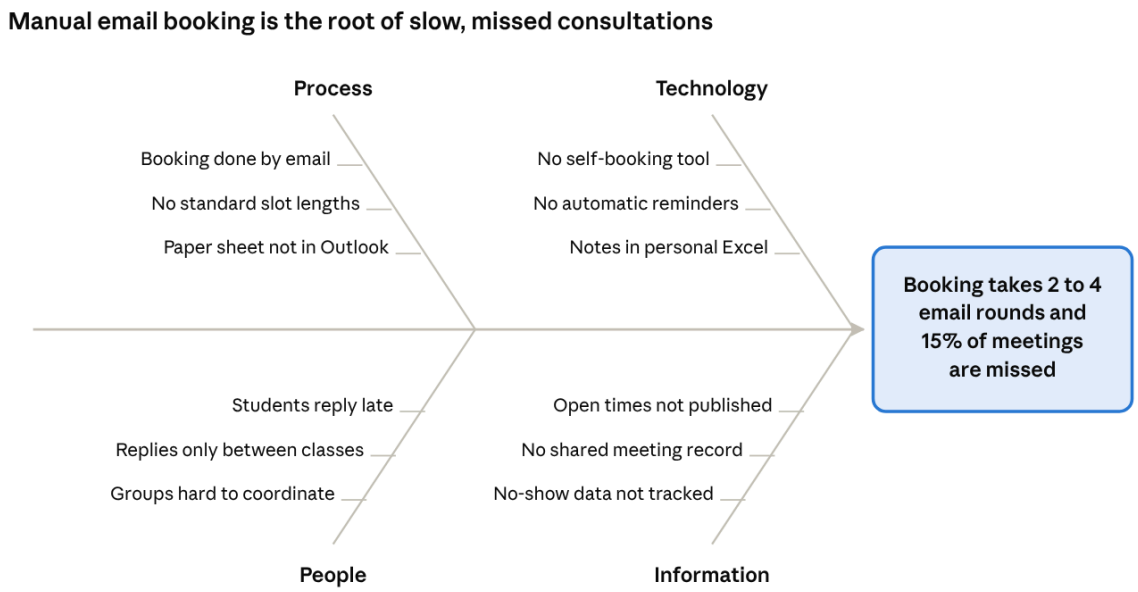
3. CATWOE analysis

The team used CATWOE instead of SWOT, as the assignment requires. It looks at the booking problem from each stakeholder's view and focuses on the new functionality.

Element	Meaning	For this system
Customers	Who benefits	Students and project groups in Walter's sections (about 120–150 a term)
Actors	Who carries out the process	Walter (instructor); later other instructors; IT Services for support
Transformation	Input → output	Booking requests by email or paper → confirmed, self-booked meetings with reminders and records
Worldview	Why it matters	Instructors should spend their time teaching and advising, not scheduling
Owner	Who can approve or stop it	BIS program, School of Business (program head)
Environment	Outside constraints	Small budget, existing Microsoft 365 and D2L Brightspace, FOIP privacy rules, deadline before Winter 2027

Root definition: A system owned by the BIS program and used by the instructor, which lets students book consultations themselves from published open slots, so that scheduling time is cut and every meeting is confirmed, reminded and recorded, within the college's existing technology, budget and privacy rules.

4. Fishbone (cause-and-effect) diagram

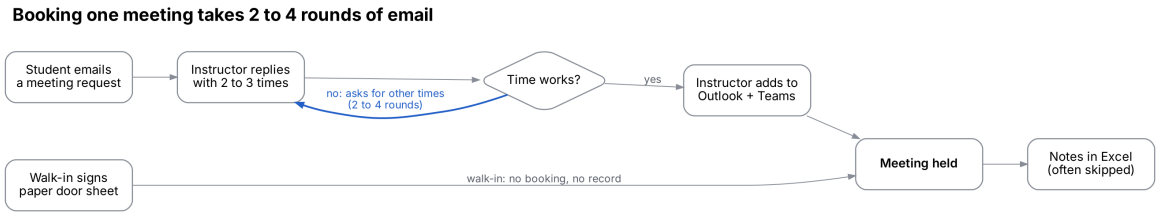


fishbone (Ishikawa) diagram · 4 categories, 12 causes

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Most causes trace back to two gaps: there is no tool for students to book themselves, and open times are not published anywhere. A self-booking system with published slots, automatic reminders and a shared meeting record addresses all 12 causes.

5. As-is business process model



as-is booking process · 6 steps, 1 loop

as-is booking process · 6 steps, 1 loop

The email loop between Walter and the student is the main delay. Walk-ins bypass the calendar entirely, which causes double-bookings, and notes are often skipped, so there is no meeting record.

Proposed (to-be) process: Student signs in → picks an open slot → confirms → system sends confirmation and adds the meeting to Outlook with a Teams link → system sends a reminder 24 hours before → meeting held → Walter records notes and status. This removes the email loop and the paper sheet.